AFTERCARE · HEALING GUIDE

Your Tattoo Healing Guide

For the first few weeks your tattoo is a healing wound. Here's what to expect at each stage, how to care for it and when to see a doctor.

YOUR LOGO

First 24 hours

Wrap, wash, rest

WRAP OFF
Plastic wrap off after [2–5] hours, or follow your film plan.

FIRST WASH
Clean hands, lukewarm water, fragrance-free soap. Rinse gently.

PAT DRY
Use a clean paper towel, then let it air-dry.

SLEEP
Clean sheets and loose clothes. A little ink on the sheets is normal.

OOZING IS NORMAL
Clear fluid and a little ink for the first [1–2] days.

Daily care

Until fully healed

WASH
[2–3] times a day. Keep a hard shower stream off it.

OINTMENT
A thin layer for [3–4] days. It should never look wet or shiny.

LOTION
Then fragrance-free lotion [2–3] times a day until healed.

CLOTHING
Loose and clean. Tight straps and waistbands rub.

NO ANTIBIOTIC CREAMS
Unless a doctor prescribes them; they can irritate.

Protect

For [2–4] weeks

NO SOAKING
No baths, pools, hot tubs, sea, lakes or saunas.

SUN
Keep it covered and out of direct sun. No tanning beds.

HANDS OFF
No picking, scratching or slapping. Let flakes fall off.

WORKOUTS
Skip gym sessions that stretch or rub it for [48] hours.

ONCE HEALED
SPF 30+ every day keeps lines crisp.

Days 1–3

Red, warm, swollen and tender, with some oozing.

Days 4–14

Flaking, peeling and itching. Don't pick or scratch.

Weeks 2–4

The surface closes. It may look cloudy or shiny.

Months 1–3

Deeper skin heals and color settles. Big pieces take longer.

THIS IS NORMAL

- Redness and swelling for [2–3] days
- Clear or ink-tinged oozing early on
- Itching, flaking and light scabbing
- A milky, cloudy look as new skin forms
- Lines that puff up in heat for a few weeks
- Small patchy spots a touch-up can fix

SEE A DOCTOR IF YOU NOTICE

- Redness or swelling that spreads after day 3
- Red streaks, heat or throbbing pain
- Yellow or green pus, or a bad smell
- Fever or chills
- A rash, hives or itchy bumps in one color
- Hard lumps that last more than a week

Call 911 for trouble breathing or a swollen face or throat. **Seen a doctor?** Please tell me too, so I can note the ink lot.

MRI scan? Rare tingling or burning can happen. Tell your radiologist about your tattoos.

YOUR TOUCH-UP WINDOW

PRODUCTS I RECOMMEND

NOTES